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16 December 1952

MEMO TO: R. Fredericks

FROM: R. Klein

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SUBJECT: Trip Report to Holloman Air Development Center, 9-10 December 1952.

The following people were contacted at HADC on 9-10 December 1952.

Major Mudd	-	Chief Maintenance Officer HADC
Major Buchanan	-	Maintenance Officer HADC
Lt. E. Hombaker	-	Project Officer MX 794
Major Delaney	-	Account ability Officer HADC
W. O. Golay	-	Supply Officer HADC
Lt. J. Smith	-	Parachute Shop
Dr. Price	-	Land Air - Mathematician
Mr. Bagley	-	Land Air - Geodesist
Mr. Holland	-	Land Air - Scheduling and Control
Mr. Martz	-	Land Air - Physicist

Lt. Hombaker has again been assigned as Project Officer on MX 794. He replaces Lt. Hazlett who will be transferred to Maxwell Field to attend Tactical Officers School.

B-29 1781 will be flown to WROC on or about the 5th of January. The crew will return immediately to HADC. There will be no time limit on keeping the airplane here. It was noted that the airplane was equipped with a radome which should be removed before delivery.

It was the opinion of several of the armorers that the S-4 & S-3 shackles would not be satisfactory for our purpose. They indicated that these heavy duty shackles sometimes hang up with a light load attached. The S-4 and S-3 shackles would also entail considerable rewiring in the bomb bays. The armorers felt that the D-7A shackle would be more reliable for our purpose. This shackle incorporated with a Type -A-4 bomb release would only require the addition of a short jumper cable to the racks to put the system in operation. Lt. Hombaker indicated that HADC could probably send an armorer with the B-29 on January 5th if we desired one.

Lt. J. D. Smith is in charge of the parachute shop. He indicated that his men are familiar with the Personnel Guide Parachute and will be able to handle any chute problems we might have. They will also be able to furnish spare 30 inch pilot parachutes, Type A-3 and quarter deployment bags.

Under the present organization at HADC, Lt. Smith is responsible for the installation of cameras and batteries in test missiles. This group depends almost entirely upon Willard wet cells for a power supply. They use four Type-NT6 or Type-EP46 cells hooked up in series. The entire pack weighing about 6 pounds. To date they have never experienced any difficulty with these batteries at altitudes as high as 36,000 feet. The standard procedure is to put a trickle charger on the battery pack over night. An hour before take off the charger is removed and the battery pack is installed.

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Mr. Holland of Land Air felt that a rough check on the trajectory could be made in about three days after the initial drops. He said the complete report would be available in approximately two weeks. Mr. Holland stated that all of the required equipment at Station Able 7 could be hooked up and made ready on short notice. The radar has been checked or actually in use at least once every two weeks.

Major Delaney, Base Accountability Officer, and Warrant Officer Colay, Base Supply Officer, feel that we may procure small expendable items under a special fund (692). In using this fund, we will be able to draw items from their supply without the transfer of any paper work between HADC and WRRC. Mr. Colay said that we could help his own group a great deal by anticipating the need for any non-standard or hard-to-get items.

Mr. Martz of Land Air felt that they had a considerable amount of pertinent information on camera installations and techniques for photographing a timing flash on the ground. He suggested the use of thyratron tubes for this purpose. Mr. Martz indicated that he would be happy to send this information on to E. Kimball. He also said that in the near future Land Air would have a photo unit which we would be able to make use of.

Lt. Hombaker checked with the Operations Officer at HAFB and found that any WRRC personnel who might be required to fly during the tests must take a high altitude indoctrination course. This course is held at Biggs Field the 1st and 4th Monday of each month. Personnel will be scheduled through the Operations Officer, HAFB.

cc: R. Rumpf
E. Kimball
K. Siegel
J. Wolf
F. Cline

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